🧩 Virtual Treasure Hunt – Round 1

Next Node – Code Hunt

Round 1 is a **technical puzzle round** where participants solve coding challenges by visiting programming documentation pages and executing code snippets.

The goal of the round is to **find the correct outputs from code examples** and use them to **unlock the final vault**.

🎯 Round Concept

The interface displays a **3 × 3 puzzle grid**.

- **8 blocks** contain coding puzzles.
- The **center block** is the **Final Vault**.

[Puzzle] [Puzzle] [Puzzle]
[Puzzle] [VAULT] [Puzzle]
[Puzzle] [Puzzle] [Puzzle]

Participants must solve all puzzles to unlock the vault.

🔀 Randomized Grid System

Each participant sees puzzles in **different positions**.

The system **shuffles puzzle locations every session**, ensuring:

- Players cannot copy answers from others
- Every player experiences a **unique layout**
- Fair play across all participants

Even though **positions change**, the **puzzles themselves remain the same**.

🧠 Puzzle Structure

Each puzzle contains a **3-step mission card**.

Step 1 – Visit the Source

Participants receive a link to a **GeeksforGeeks article**.

Example:

> Visit the GeeksforGeeks article on **Python Lists**.

Step 2 – Locate the Code Example

Participants must identify a **specific code snippet** described in the puzzle.

Example:

> Find the code example that creates a list called `thislist`.

Step 3 – Execute and Find Output

Participants must:

1. Run the code using **GeeksforGeeks IDE** or their **own compiler**
2. Identify the correct output

Example question:

> What is the **second element printed**?

They then **enter the answer into the puzzle box**.

📚 Puzzle Topics

The puzzles cover **multiple programming languages and concepts**.

Puzzle	Topic
ALPHA	Python Lists
BETA	Java Arrays
GAMMA	Python Dictionaries
DELTA	JavaScript Arrays
EPSILON	Python Stack
ZETA	Java String Length
ETA	Python String Methods
THETA	Java Math Functions

This ensures the round tests **general programming knowledge**, not just one language.

🔓 Puzzle Unlock Mechanism

When the participant enters the **correct answer**:

- The puzzle **unlocks**
- The **correct output is displayed**
- A **visual confirmation** appears on the puzzle card

This allows players to **track their solved puzzles**.

📊 Progress Tracking

A **progress bar** at the top of the page shows:

- Number of puzzles solved
- Remaining puzzles
- Vault status

Example:

3 / 8 solved
5 puzzles remaining

Once **all 8 puzzles are solved**, the **Final Vault becomes accessible**.

🔑 Final Vault Challenge

After solving all puzzles, participants must generate a **Master Key**.

Rule

Take the **first character of each answer**
in **alphabetical order of puzzles (A → H)**.

Example

Puzzle	Answer	First Letter
A	BANANA	B
B	5	5
C	FORD	F
D	5	5
E	3	3
F	13	1
G	GEEKSFORGEEKS	G
H	5	5

Final Key

B5F531G5

Participants enter this **key into the center vault block**.

🏆 Final Reward

When the **correct master key** is entered:

- The **vault unlocks**
- A **secret flag appears in browser developer tools**

Participants must open:

F12 → Console

The **final treasure flag** can be discovered in:

- Console output
- `localStorage`
- Network requests
- JavaScript global variables

This encourages exploration of **browser developer tools**.

🧪 Skills Tested in Round 1

This round evaluates several technical abilities:

- Code reading and understanding
- Running code snippets
- Debugging logic
- Web navigation and research
- Basic developer tools usage

The round encourages participants to **interact with real programming resources** instead of answering purely theoretical questions.

🚀 End Goal

Solve **8 coding puzzles → Generate Master Key → Unlock Vault → Find the Treasure Flag**.